

Building Comixit

a Children's Reading App

Sector: Media and Publishing · Client: Comixit

Challenge

Comixit's founder, a scriptwriter and publisher from the film and book world, wanted to tackle a problem he kept seeing firsthand: children spending hours watching videos on their parents' phones instead of reading. It's a bigger issue than it sounds — a significant number of children in the UK leave primary school without the basic literacy skills they need for secondary education, and this was happening in the same year the government was actively promoting reading in schools. The founder had an initial idea and an early proof of concept for a children's comics app, but it needed real product thinking and engineering behind it to become something investors and major publishers would take seriously.

Solution

We built a fully functioning Android and iOS app with free and subscription tiers, giving parents the ability to monitor and control their children's access while letting kids read comics from major publishers including exclusive content from Disney and the Beano. Behind the app sits an extensive backend for onboarding new publishers and a system that lets children safely create and upload their own comics and characters. One of the harder technical problems was using AI to take a publisher's source files and turn them into a format that works on a phone screen, without the constant pinching and zooming that ruins the experience — an engine that reformats comics into a vertical scrolling, frame-by-frame layout, while leaving the original artwork untouched to respect publisher copyright. Our involvement went beyond code: we helped shape the business case and investor deck, provided fractional CTO support, and brought in product ownership and project management to keep a fast-moving, bootstrapped startup on track.

Effects

Once the app was live, Comixit secured exclusive UK licensing agreements with both Disney and the publisher of the Beano — deals that depended on having a working product to show. The app is still live and still growing today.

Stack: React Native, Expo, C#, ASP.NET, AWS, Terraform

